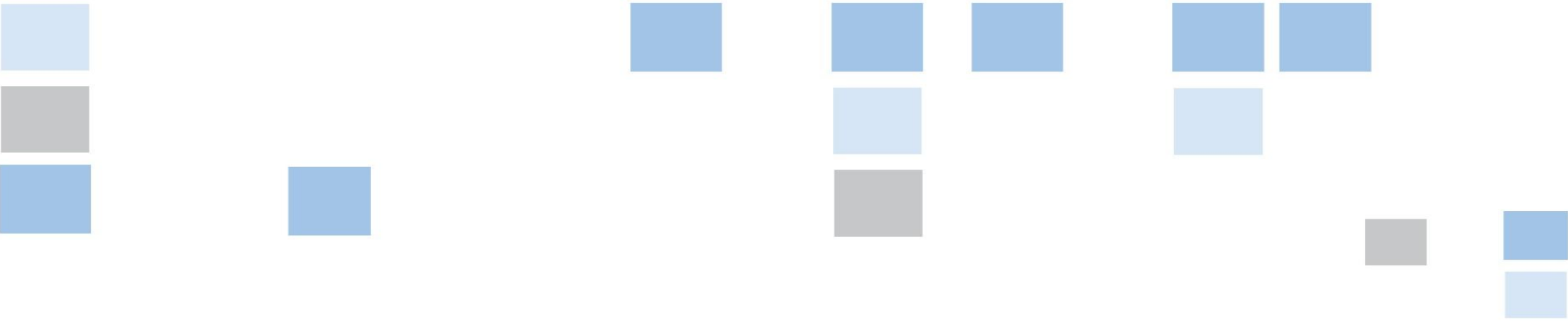


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OM-Management Skills

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— Margaret Mead

Never doubt that a small group of thoughtful, committed people can change the world. Indeed, it is the only way that it ever has.

– Margaret Mead (cultural anthropologist)

Advantages of Teams

- Increased **information and knowledge**
- **Increased diversity** of views
- Increased **acceptance** of a solution
- Higher **performance** levels

(Bouveé and Thill)



Disadvantages of Teams

- **Groupthink**
- Hidden **agendas**
- **Cost**



(Bouveé and Thill)



Groups and Complex Problem Solving

- **Groups of 3,4 and 5 perform better** on complex problem-solving than than the best of an equivalent number of individuals.
- **Groups of 2 performed at the same level as the best of 2 individuals**, suggesting that this group size is too small for optimal problem-solving.

(APA, 2006)

What makes a great team?



Traits of Effective Teams

(Bovée and Thill)

Objective and purpose

Strong trust

Communication

Decision making

Creative

Can resolve conflicts

Group phases (Tuckman)

Table 19.2 Tuckman's Linear Model of Group Development

Stages	Activities
Forming	Members come together, learn about each other, and determine the purpose of the group.
Storming	Members engage in more direct communication and get to know each other. Conflicts between group members will often arise during this stage.
Norming	Members establish spoken or unspoken rules about how they communicate and work. Status, rank, and roles in the group are established.
Performing	Members fulfill their purpose and reach their goal.
Adjourning	Members leave the group.



TEAM LEADERSHIP

*"No leader can make a team perform well. But all leaders can **create conditions** that **increase the likelihood** that it will."*

(J. Richard Hackman, expert in team dynamics, Harvard, 2002)

Hackman's Leadership Attribution Error

“Our tendency to assign to the leader credit or blame for successes or failures that actually are *team outcomes*” (Hackman, 2004).

Building Teams (Hackman)

- **Teams must be real** (know who is on the team, leader's responsibility)
- **Teams need a compelling direction** (what they're supposed to be doing together)
- **Teams need enabling structures** (appropriate tasks and norms)
- **Teams need a supportive organization** (rewards, information)
- **Teams need expert coaching** (as a group)

Read for this week

- Read “Why Teams Don’t Work” (Hackman and Coutu), see instructions for library access on eStudy